



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Central Christian Academy
School Website: <https://ccaschool.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit Report: Austin Classical School**

Website audited: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school explicitly grounds its mission in Christ (“glorify Jesus Christ”) and in cultivating “wise, virtuous, and humble” students through a “classical, Christian education,” and it frames the aim, method, and tools of education around Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and the Trivium with Great Books and the Great Conversation. Clear evidence for classical curriculum and pedagogy appears across multiple pages. Evidence for faculty formation language and parent formation programming is thinner in the public pages sampled. - Method note: This audit follows the Six Essential Elements framework and its Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators (for example: “truth, goodness, beauty,” “Trivium,” “Socratic,” “scholé,” and negatives like “project-based learning” when used as a dominant paradigm), cross-checked against the classicality lexicon.

How to read the scores - Each category below includes: (1) school keywords found; (2) comparison to the positive/negative indicators from the Six Elements; (3) a positive vs. negative tally and estimated coverage; and (4) a rating per category.

Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations 1) School terms found (from public pages) - “glorify Jesus Christ”; “classical, Christian education”; “To cultivate wisdom and virtue so that the love of God may abound”; “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty”; “under the sovereignty of God through theology”; “study the Bible.”

2) Match to Six Elements positive/negative indicators

- Positive matches: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; theology; Bible; God; Christian worldview. These align with “Transcendental moral realism,” “Grounded in Theology,” and a theologically integrated worldview.
- Negative matches: none observed (no “values-neutral,” “subjective truth,” etc.).

3) Tally and coverage

- Positive hits: +10; Negative hits: -0 → 100% positive
- Estimated coverage of this element: 0.85 (strong transcendental/theological language; no explicit public mention of daily chapel/liturgy on sampled pages)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Justification: Strong, explicit Christian telos anchored in truth, goodness, and beauty, and theological integration.
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Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal 1) School terms found - “To cultivate wisdom and virtue so that the love of God may abound”; “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”; “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose”; “great ideas,” “great books,” “great conversation.”

2) Match to Six Elements indicators

- Positive matches: cultivate wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation over information; great conversation.
- Negative matches: none observed (no “college and career readiness” emphasis).

3) Tally and coverage

- Positive hits: +8; Negative hits: -0 → 100% positive
- Estimated coverage: 0.95 (purpose repeatedly and explicitly stated)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Justification: The telos of education is clearly formation in wisdom and virtue, not job prep.

Element 3 — Curriculum 1) School terms found - “Trivium ... Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric”; “Great Books ... Great Conversation”; “Latin (beginning in 5th grade) ... formal logic ... rhetoric instruction”; “we study the Bible, the great works of the Western tradition, history, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin ... art, music, math, and science”; “interrelation of all knowledge ... under the sovereignty of God through theology.”

2) Match to Six Elements indicators

- Positive matches: liberal arts/Trivium; great books/primary texts; Latin; history (not “social studies”); integrated/harmonious curriculum; rhetoric.
- Negative matches: none observed (no “project-based learning dominance,” “STEM-first framing,” or “social studies” replacement language).

3) Tally and coverage

- Positive hits: +11; Negative hits: -0 → 100% positive
- Estimated coverage: 0.92 (very full Trivium/Great Books/Latin/history integration; Quadrivium not named explicitly but arts/sciences present)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Justification: Clear commitment to the Trivium, Latin, Great Books, and integrated study.

Element 4 — Pedagogy (Teaching Methods) 1) School terms found - Grammar stage: “memorization, recitation, and songs”; Logic stage: “debate and discussion”; Rhetoric stage: “thesis defense and eloquent written and oral communication.” - “idea-focused instruction” under classical method overview.

2) Match to Six Elements indicators

- Positive matches: memorization/recitation/singing; discussion/debate; rhetoric training and oration; memory work—core lower-school practices.
- Missing/neutral: “Socratic” and “scholé/restful” are not explicitly named on the sampled pages (though practices align in spirit).
- Negative matches: none observed (no “project-based/experiential learning” as the dominant method).

3) Tally and coverage

- Positive hits: +7; Negative hits: -0 → 100% positive
- Estimated coverage: 0.80 (strong lower- and upper-school practices; explicit “Socratic/scholé” terms not seen)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Justification: Pedagogy highlights singing/memory in K-8 and debate/discussion/rhetoric in upper years, matching classical norms.

Element 5 — Faculty 1) School terms found - Public page reference: “Employment page lists the qualifications ... along with any open positions” (no additional faculty information or “teachers as mentors/virtuous exemplars” language surfaced in the crawl sample).

2) Match to Six Elements indicators

- Positive matches: none explicitly surfaced (e.g., “teachers as models of virtue,” “faculty of friends,” “portrait of a teacher” were not found on sampled pages).
- Negative matches: none.

3) Tally and coverage

- Positive hits: +0; Negative hits: -0 → n/a (no hits)
- Estimated coverage: 0.15 (insufficient public statements to score more fully)

4) Rating: NOT CLASSICAL (due to lack of public evidence)

- Justification: The site may have relevant language elsewhere, but the sampled pages do not evidence a faculty philosophy aligned to the classical indicators.

Element 6 — Parents and Community 1) School terms found - “co-laboring with families” in the mission statement; partnership emphasis present.

2) Match to Six Elements indicators

- Positive matches: parent partnership (co-laboring).
- Missing/neutral: explicit “parent formation” programming, book clubs, or open-campus visitation norms not surfaced on sampled pages.
- Negative matches: none.

3) Tally and coverage

- Positive hits: +1; Negative hits: -0 → 100% positive
- Estimated coverage: 0.35 (partnership is affirmed; details about parent education not evident)

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Justification: Clear partnership language, but limited public detail on parent formation offerings.

Aggregate Rating: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Robust classical language and implementation in mission, aims, curriculum, and pedagogy (Categories 1–4) outweigh thinner public evidence in Faculty and Parents/Community (Categories 5–6). Using the Six Elements keyword framework—e.g., truth/goodness/beauty; Trivium; great books; Latin; recitation/chanting; rhetoric; and the absence of negative markers like “21st-century skills” or “project-based learning” as a dominant paradigm—the school clearly aligns with classical education.

Detailed Keyword Tables by Category (Positive vs. Negative)

- Element 1 (Religious/Metaphysical)
 - School keywords matched: Jesus Christ; Christian; truth; goodness; beauty; wisdom; virtue; theology; God; Bible.
 - Negatives found: none.
 - Tally: +10 / -0 → 100% positive
- Element 2 (Purpose/Goal)
 - School keywords matched: cultivate wisdom and virtue; love of God; truth, goodness, beauty; great conversation; eternal purpose (not job training).

- Negatives found: none (no college/career-ready emphasis).
 - Tally: +8 / -0 → 100% positive
 - Element 3 (Curriculum)
 - School keywords matched: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Latin; Great Books; history; Bible; integrated curriculum; rhetoric instruction.
 - Negatives found: none (no social studies replacement language; no STEM-first framing; no PBL dominance).
 - Tally: +11 / -0 → 100% positive
 - Element 4 (Pedagogy)
 - School keywords matched: memorization; recitation; songs; debate; discussion; thesis defense; rhetoric/oral communication.
 - Missing: "Socratic," "scholé/restful" as explicit terms.
 - Negatives found: none (no experiential/PBL dominance).
 - Tally: +7 / -0 → 100% positive
 - Element 5 (Faculty)
 - School keywords matched: none surfaced beyond employment page reference.
 - Negatives found: none.
 - Tally: +0 / -0
 - Element 6 (Parents & Community)
 - School keywords matched: "co-laboring with families" (parent partnership).
 - Negatives found: none.
 - Tally: +1 / -0 → 100% positive
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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